

YARDZEN · VISUAL IDENTITY SYSTEM

Brand Book 2026

A complete visual identity for Yardzen — designed, documented, and built so every team can use it without asking anyone's permission.

ENGAGEMENT

Fixed scope · September – December 2026

INVESTMENT

\$24,000 USD

PREPARED FOR

Brian Radics, Yardzen

PREPARED BY

Daniel Pliego, Casa Soda

CONTENTS

- Why now — and what it costs today
- Investment, and how it fits what Yardzen already spends
- Who owns what
- What's in the book
- Timeline and team
- How we work together
- Terms

01

Why now

Yardzen's landscape design work is held to a standard the brand around it is not. Your brief names the gap plainly:

"Erosion of the brand equity due to a lack of adherence to standards and less oversight into how Yardzen shows up across omnichannel touchpoints: inconsistent font usage, varying tones of voice, lack of brand breakthrough, and brand visuals that lack the quality standards expected."

That erosion has a cost, and you've already connected it to revenue — stronger brand design means **more client leads and more design purchases**. This proposal treats it that way. Not a brand book as an artifact, but the thing that stops the leak while the business is working to grow.

What inconsistency costs today

Every marketing request is currently answered from scratch. Someone picks a typeface, chooses a crop, guesses at a colour, and a portion of the output lands off-brand. That work is slow, it's expensive, and it's the reason the standards slip — not because anyone ignores the brand, but because there is no system that makes doing it right faster than doing it wrong.

A working identity system inverts that. The right answer becomes the quickest one. Requests that used to be bespoke design jobs become template fills, and the teams asking stop needing a designer in the loop to stay on brand.

What this is aiming at

Your five objectives frame the work, and each one has a concrete answer in the deliverables:

01	Consistency at scale A flexible visual system that adapts across Clients, Contractors and Partners without fragmenting.
02	Distinctiveness Proprietary, recognisable assets — a compositional system, not a logo on a page.
03	Elevated perception A premium, design-led identity that makes the promise of a premium landscape credible before anyone reads a word.
04	Instill intent An art direction that associates Yardzen with aspiration, outdoor living and transformation.
05	Lifestyle brand community A mark with enough character that people are willing to wear it, display it and identify with it.

Investment

The Brand Book is a fixed-scope project of **\$24,000 USD**, delivered September through December.

Most of that is not new spend. Yardzen already funds design system and marketing work every month — it simply runs without a brand behind it. During the build, that budget points at the book instead. The table shows the whole picture, including what Yardzen pays today.

LINE	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCT–DEC each	Q1
Product	\$9k	\$9k	\$9k	\$9k
Code Design System	\$3k	\$3k	\$1k	\$1k
Marketing asks	\$1k	—	\$1k	\$1k
Brand	—	\$3k	\$7k	\$4k
		<i>logo directions</i>	<i>build the book</i>	<i>adoption + expansion</i>
Yardzen pays	\$13k	\$15k	\$18k	\$15k

Brand Book project — \$24,000. September \$3k, plus \$7k in each of October, November and December. Fixed scope with a defined end. This is the only figure being quoted. Q1 is shown as direction, not commitment — it gets scoped once the book exists.

What each period buys

SEP	\$3k · Direction and first logo routes Territories, the strategic frame for the identity, and initial logo directions in front of you by September 29 . A short, high-intensity sprint against your date.
OCT	\$7k · The chosen mark, colour and type Logo architecture resolved. Colour system and typography system built out.
NOV	\$7k · Complete visual identity Graphic elements, iconography, art direction, and the visual principles governing photography, AI artwork, video and cropping.
DEC	\$7k · Applications and the book Eight application templates, then the full Brand Guidelines compiled and handed over.

Payment

Billed monthly: 50% at the start of each month, 50% on that month's approval. Invoiced separately from the product retainer. Intellectual property in all delivered work transfers to Yardzen on final payment.

How it fits current scope

Yardzen and Casa Soda already work together every month. This project is designed to sit inside that relationship rather than beside it.

Product is protected

Product holds at **\$9k in every period**, unchanged from today. It does not drop to fund the brand work, and brand deadlines never compete with product delivery for the same hours. A dedicated brand designer joins the team for this engagement, and Said leads brand execution — the brand work is staffed separately by design.

Design system and marketing work fold in

Today \$3k a month goes to the code design system and roughly \$1k to ad-hoc marketing requests. Both are brand work already; they just have no brand to work from. During the build they reduce rather than disappear — enough to keep the lights on, with the balance redirected into producing the system they've been improvising around.

The marketing requests are the clearest case. The eight application templates in this book are the permanent answer to work that is currently re-invented every time it's asked for.

We deliberately do not repaint the product yet

An unreleased brand should not be applied to live product UI. Through October to December we align the **structure** of the design tokens to the incoming brand and flag conflicts, but we do not restyle the product against a system still under review. Applying it early means doing it twice.

That implementation is what Q1 is for. The book lands in the product once it is approved, not while it is being decided.

Typefaces stay as they are

The type system is built from **Arsenal**, **Geist** and one further open-licence face selected in September. No custom typeface is commissioned and no licensing cost is introduced. Arsenal is already Yardzen's display face and Geist already runs in the product, so the book documents and disciplines what exists rather than replacing it — which means the design tokens change roles, not families.

Who owns what

The Brand Book has two halves and they are built by different teams. This proposal covers the visual half only.

Yardzen owns

BRAND FOUNDATION

- Vision and mission
- Target audience profile
- Positioning statement and communications platform
- Copywriting tone of voice
- Out-of-category reference brands

Casa Soda owns

VISUAL IDENTITY

- Core visual identity
- Visual principles
- Applications
- Guidance and governance
- Compilation of the complete book

Brand Foundation is needed by the **end of September**. Logo and identity directions can begin without it, but colour, type and art direction all resolve against positioning and audience — if Foundation arrives late, the October work compresses.

DECISION-MAKING

Responsible	Casa Soda
Accountable	Brian Radics — single approver
Consulted	Allison, Alicia, Adam
Informed	Alison, Marketing team

One accountable approver matters more on this project than most. A visual identity reviewed by committee converges on the least objectionable option, which is the opposite of the distinctiveness the brief asks for. Consultation is welcome at every stage; the decision sits in one place.

What's in the book

The complete list of what Casa Soda delivers. Everything named here is included in the \$24,000. Anything not named here is a change order.

A · Core Visual Identity

- **Logo architecture** — the full system of marks and how they relate
 - **Symbol / short-form logo and derivatives.** We explore "YZ" in multiple iterations, and evaluate the current "**Y**" **in the circle** both standalone and accompanied by the Yardzen wordmark. The symbol is designed to carry the lifestyle-brand ambition — a mark that works on a hat as well as a header
 - **Lockups** — primary, secondary and vertical; safe areas; minimum sizes; placement rules; dos and don'ts
 - **Colour system** — core palette with HEX, RGB, CMYK and Pantone values; usage ratios; and the rule for deriving new accent colours so the palette can extend without drifting
 - **Typography system** — Arsenal, Geist and one further open-licence face; type scale; type lockups; casing and usage rules
 - **Graphic elements** — the proprietary devices that make a layout recognisably Yardzen at a glance
 - **Iconography** — style definition and a core set
 - **Art direction** — how the parts compose into a consistent world
-

B · Visual Principles

- **Photography** — principles, style and treatment, so real Yardzen project work is presented to a single standard
- **AI-generated artwork** — where it is appropriate, where it is not, and how it must be treated to stay credible
- **The role of humanity** — when people appear, how, and why
- **Video** — direction and treatment guidance
- **Angles and cropping** — the rules that keep composition consistent across everyone who touches an image

C · Applications

One representative, fully designed template for each named surface — eight in total:

- Website
- Advertising
- Social media
- Paid digital media
- Mailers
- Partner decks
- Signage
- Apparel and swag

What "one template per surface" means. Each template is a complete, specified, editable design — the pattern that every future piece on that surface is built from. It is not every size, format or variant a surface will eventually need. Additional templates, sizes and variants are available as a change order at **\$2,500 each**, and are the natural first work of Q1.

D · Guidance

- **Rules for internal and external teams** — written so a contractor, a partner or a new marketing hire can apply the brand correctly without a briefing
- **The compositional system** — the grid, headline zones, call-to-action placement and contextual type usage. This is the part that makes the identity a system rather than a style sheet, and the reason marketing can self-serve
- **Sub-brand derivation rule** — how any future sub-brand takes its colour and lockup from the master brand without a new design project each time
- **Co-branding rules** — how Yardzen sits alongside a partner's mark, so partner work stops being negotiated case by case

On sub-brands. The book delivers the rule, not the sub-brands. Resolving named sub-brands as finished identities is separate work, and it is the right candidate for Q1 — the rule has to exist before they can be derived from it.

Format

Delivered as a complete **Brand Guidelines PDF**, plus the editable source files and exported logo and asset packs in the formats each surface needs.

Timeline

Four months, starting immediately. The schedule is built around your **September 29** date for first logo directions.

SEP	Direction Territories and strategic frame. Third typeface selected. First logo directions presented by September 29. Brand Foundation received from Yardzen by month end.
OCT	The mark Logo direction chosen and resolved into the full architecture — symbol, wordmark, lockups, safe areas. Colour system and typography system built.
NOV	The system Graphic elements, iconography, art direction. Visual principles for photography, AI artwork, humanity, video, angles and cropping. The compositional system defined.
DEC	Applications and handoff Eight application templates designed and specified. Guidance and governance written. Complete Brand Guidelines compiled, source files packaged, handed over.

TEAM

Daniel Pliego	Direction, strategy, client, final review
Said	Branding execution lead
Brand designer	Dedicated to this engagement
Quetzalli	Production support

A dedicated brand designer joins the team for this engagement. Casa Soda is adding capacity for this work specifically — the brand book is not being absorbed into the existing product team's week.

07

How we work together

A weekly branding review

Brand progress gets its own standing weekly review, **separate from the product meeting**. Two reasons. Brand decisions need the people who decide brand in the room, which is not the same group as product. And on a four-month fixed schedule, a review that shares an agenda with product is a review that gets postponed — which turns into a missed approval, which turns into a missed deadline.

Product changes carry to Q1

Product holds its agreed shape from October through December. If product scope expands during those months, **the additional work is carried into Q1** rather than absorbed alongside the brand build.

This protects both sides of the engagement. It keeps the December handoff real, and it means new product priorities are scheduled honestly instead of quietly competing with a fixed-date deliverable.

Revisions

Two revision rounds per stage, included. A round is one consolidated set of feedback from the approver — not sequential opinions arriving separately. Further rounds are available at \$1,500 each.

08

Terms

Fee	\$24,000 USD, fixed scope
Schedule	\$3k September · \$7k October, November, December
Billing	50% at start of month, 50% on that month's approval
Revisions	2 rounds per stage · additional \$1,500 each
Extra templates	\$2,500 each
Intellectual property	Transfers to Yardzen on final payment
Product retainer	Separate line, unaffected, invoiced separately

WHAT WE NEED FROM YARDZEN

- Brand Foundation delivered by end of September
- A single approver — Brian Radics

- Consolidated feedback within five working days of each presentation
- Access to the photography library and existing brand assets
- Attendance at the weekly branding review

After the book

A brand book that is delivered and not adopted has changed nothing.

Q1 is where the system stops being a document. It is shown in the table as direction rather than commitment — the scope gets defined once the book exists and we can both see what it actually needs. Two things are already clear:

Adoption

The identity implemented in the product. Design tokens updated from structure to values, components restyled, the code design system brought onto the approved brand. This is the work deliberately held back during the build, and it is why the code design system line returns in Q1.

Expansion

Sub-brands derived through the rule the book establishes. Additional application templates, sizes and variants for the surfaces marketing uses most. Anything the December handoff identified as next.

IN SUMMARY

Brand Book 2026	\$24,000 USD · September – December
First logo directions	September 29, 2026
Handoff	December 2026
Peak monthly spend	\$18,000 · October to December

Yardzen's brief asks for a world-class, distinctive, design-led brand worthy of the landscape work behind it. That is the right ambition and it is an achievable one — the raw material is already there in the projects Yardzen delivers every week. What has been missing is the system that presents them to a single standard.

THANK YOU,

Daniel Pliego CASA SODA

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